



Maulik Jasubhai Publisher

Publisher's Note

Some people ask, why this devotion to technology? It's not an idle question, and I shall attempt to answer it. First, India is a developing country, but when it comes to IT, we have a global presence. We're a force in the global arena, respected for our prowess, and other countries are suddenly trying to emulate us. Within the country, as open source percolates, as the digital divide is bridged, with people taking to computing in regional languages, with IT awareness spreading to the remotest corners of the country, with prices coming down sharply—

The Power Of Five

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t's clear enough from the packaging of what you just bought, but let me state it formally: *Digit* this month celebrates its Fifth Anniversary. It's been five exciting years of keeping you, our readers, in touch with how the technology saga has been progressing; Five great years of infotainment and innovation; Five fabulous years of focusing on the present and looking fondly to the future.

What's special about Five? Man has always given the number Five special treatment: think of the five-pointed star, or the pentagram, which wards off evil. Or of the five elements. Or of the five virtues. Coming down to earth, five translates to half a decade, so we can now speak about ourselves in terms of decades rather than merely months and years. Half a decade is a lot in Internet time, as you're all too aware! Then there's the power of your hand with its five fingers: from what I can see, the trend has been towards putting everything in your hands. Whether it's figuratively—as in control and ease of use—or literally, as in mobile devices. I've been fascinated by how everything is shrinking.

When we started off in 2001, we knew we'd be do well. Becoming India's Number One Technology magazine by far has validated our confidence. We think we've been ably doing our bit to promote interest in information technology in India. Sure, we talk a lot about technology in the personal sphere, but that's where it begins: as an interest, as a hobby, as an obsession—and then comes the drive to, for example, base a career around it. Yes, we believe we've been changing lives over the past five years. Letters from you, our readers, are testimony to this.

who knows what the IT landscape will be five years hence? Sure, we are yet to improve the infrastructure in our cities, but when the world talks about India, it's now about our growth as an IT force, about our place in the sun.

Second, technology is what is propelling us into the future, a point I do not need to belabour. Tech brands are competing with traditional ones in terms of popularity. Tech products and developments top peoples' wish-lists. "Progress" almost means "technological progress."

Finally, it's technology that connects us to the world. We may be a developing country, but when someone reads a blog post of yours, your national economic situation does not show. What shows is how much we're in step with the rest of the world. We're an integral part of the global community—and I must stress that this was not the case earlier—the Internet, that great leveller, has enabled this transition. And we adapted.

And so, as much as we're celebrating the five years that have gone by, we're eagerly anticipating what coming years will bring. We don't need to make a New Year resolution, as it were: we'll continue doing what we've been doing. I believe we've been doing it well.

Enjoy this, our Five-Star issue—and stay tuned for much more to come!